Guidelines for Preparation of Project Proposal

ITE 3962 – Final Year Project

Bachelor of Information Technology (External) Degree
Faculty of Information Technology
University of Moratuwa

General Guidelines for Prepare Project Proposal

Introduction

Your project proposal must justify the importance of the problem, your ability to solve the problem and the soundness of the solution. It must be prepared in accordance with the following instructions that come under sections of General Guidelines and Structure of the Proposal in this document

Submission: Upload the pdf version of project proposal that is prepared as per the following instructions to the Moodle.

Name the proposal as **Surname_Initials_RegistrationNo"**.

Length: It must be of minimum 4 pages: excluding the title page and table of contents.

Lettering: Times New Roman.

Spacing: Single line spacing Margins: Left, 1-1/4 inches; top, bottom, and right, 1 inch.

Sections/sub sections: The proposal must be structured with the sections listed under the 'Body of the Proposal' given below. The Arabic numbering system must be used for numbering of Sections/Subsections.

Tables and Figures: All Tables and Figures must be named with captions, and cited inside the text.

References and Citations: The list of references must be arranged in the alphabetical order of the name of the first author, and numbered in square brackets. The corresponding number of a reference must be used to cite the particular work inside the text. All items in the list of references must be cited inside the text.

Pagination: Each page should have page numbers except the "Title" page. Lower case Roman numerals should be assigned centered at the bottom of the page to all "preliminary pages" (Refer Appendix II; i - ix in content page). Pagination of the body text and appendices is to be in Arabic numerals centered at the bottom of the page. The pagination begins with the first page of the "Introduction" and continues throughout the rest of the text.

Tables & Figures: Tables are grids consisting of columns and rows that present numerical or verbal facts by categories. Figures include charts, graphs, diagrams,

photographs, maps, drawings and other images. All these types of non-textual material are collectively referred to as illustrations.

All tables and figures must be referred to in the text by number (not by a phrase such as "the following table"). Charts, graphs, maps, and tables that are larger than the standard page should be attached as Appendices. Tables, illustrations and captions should be centered (See figure 1 and table 1).

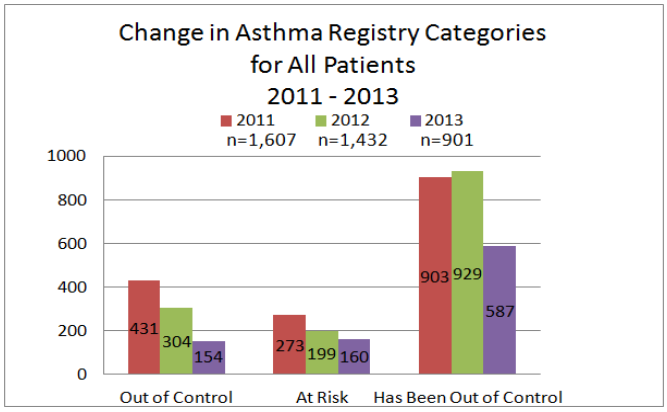


Figure 1: Asthma Registry Categories
Source: http://www.pamf.org/asthma/education/outcomes.html

Computer literacy rate by sector and province – 2014, 2015 & 2016 (during 1st 6 months).

Sector/Province	Computer literacy rate (%)		
	2014	2015	2016
Sri Lanka	**24.8**	**26.6**	**27.5**
Sector			
Urban	34.5	39.9	38.5
Rural	23.6	24.8	26.1
Estate	6.0	7.9	9.9
Province			
Western	34.2	38.2	38.5
Central	24.1	25.5	26.0
Southern	25.4	26.8	27.2
Northern	17.4	19.9	19.9
Eastern	15.9	12.8	13.4
North Western	22.5	24.2	27.3
North Central	15.3	21.2	21.6
Uva	16.7	16.8	18.5
Sabaragamuwa	22.5	20.7	23.4

Table 1: Computer Literacy Rate in Sri Lanka – 2016
Source: http://www.statistics.gov.lk/education/ComputerLiteracy-2016.pdf

Whenever there is a figure/table, you must cite it using the caption of the figure/table within the text. If a figure/table is not cited and explained within the text, such figures/tables are inappropriate to include in the document.

Organizing the Project Proposal: You should assemble the following items in the order given, in composing the final documentation. Details of these topics are given below.

- Cover Page
- Table of Contents
- List of Figures
- List of Tables
- List of abbreviations
- List of Appendices
- Introduction
- Background and Motivation
- Your Problem in Brief
- Proposed Solution
- Reference List
- Appendix A: Title
- Appendix B: Title

Structure of the Project Proposal

The proposal must be structured with the cover page, table of content, preliminary pages and the headings listed below. Note that the names of the headings given below are too generic and you may rename them to reflect your project. All headings must be numbered (12 font, bold), and the body of the text must be 12 in font size.

ITE 3962 – Final Year Project

Project Proposal

<Project Title>

Submitted by:

<Registration Number>

<Name with Initials>

Bachelor of Information Technology (External Degree)

Faculty of Information Technology

University of Moratuwa

Table of Content

<This is a list of sections and subsections with page numbers. Although a project proposal has only a few pages, it would be nice to include a table of contents for the proposal (A Sample given below)>

TABLE OF CONTENTS

List of Figures i

List of Tables ii

List of abbreviations iii

List of Appendices iv

1. Introduction 1
2. Background & Motivation 2
3. Your Problem in Brief 3
4. Aim & Objectives 3
5. Proposed Solution 4

Reference List 5

Appendix A: Title 6

Appendix B: Title 7

LIST OF FIGURES

		Page
Figure 1.1	Figure Name	2
Figure 1.2	Figure Name	3
Figure 2.1	Figure Name	4
Figure 2.2	Figure Name	5

LIST OF TABLES

		Page
Table 3.1	Table Name	2
Table 3.2	Table Name	3
Table 4.1	Table Name	4
Table 4.2	Table Name	4

LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

Abbreviation	**Description**
ACM	Association for Computing Machinery
IEEE	Institute of Electrical and Electronic Engineers
CODL	Center for Open and Distance Learning

LIST OF APPENDICES

Appendix	**Description**	**Page**
Appendix - A	Plan of actions	5

1. Introduction

<This is the first chapter/part of your proposal. Introduction is the part of the document that tries to introduce the document in an interesting manner to the reader. Introduction is all about what a reader can expect in the document, in a concise manner. However, the introduction contains all the major points that are actually covered in the document. Introduction has to be presented in such a manner so that it lures the reader into reading the entire document.

Therefore, this section must give a brief description about the problem area, the problem that you address, the importance of the problem, technology to solve the problem and the nature of the solution you propose.>

2. Background & Motivation

<This is one of the most important sections of a project proposal. Background of a project proposal is written with the intention of clarifying the importance and the necessity of the project in the first place. Why the study and what the basic purpose behind the project are the major questions that are answered through background that is presented with a project proposal. It is hard to expect a reader to read the full document without creating a background as to what made the writer prepare the document. Background information is necessary as often a reader is interested in knowing the incidents prior to the project. It is like the foundation stone of a building upon which the entire edifice later stands.

This section finally points out the problem that you address in the project. If the problem is not worth addressing, then there is no project! Here you should describe the background of the problem domain you selected. Write ***why the problem is so important to solve.*** *Whenever possible, support the importance of the problem with some references, key persons/sources. Also explain* ***why you are motivated****, and your capability to address the problem. At the end of this section, you may have pointed out several issues, but arguably identified one exact problem to solve.>*

3. Problem you address in brief

<You may rename this heading to reflect the problem that you address. For example, the heading can be: Major issue – Communication gap.

The problem is a paragraph or more in length. It describes the ***problem*** *you are aiming to solve. You don't have to say how you intend to solve the problem, only*

what the problem *is. Since the previous section pointed out several problems, here briefly write the specific problem that you are going to address.>*

4. Aim & Objectives

<This section describes what will be accomplished or tested in the project. The primary focus of your research project is usually expressed in terms of aims and objectives>

***Aim** = what you hope to achieve.*

***Objective** = the action(s) you will take in order to achieve the aim.*

***Aims** are statements of intent. They are usually written in broad terms. They set out what you hope to achieve at the end of the project.*

Write a sentence similar to 'The aim of this project is to develop a system for addressing **<your problem>.**

***Objectives**, on the other hand, should be specific statements that define measurable outcomes, e.g. what steps will be taken to achieve the desired outcome. When writing your objectives try to use strong positive statements.*

build, collect, construct, classify, develop, devise, measure, produce, revise, select, synthesize etc.

When writing aims, use active and measurable terms, ***e.g.,*** **to identify, to characterize *vs.* to study**

***Sample:** How to write aim and objectives (extracted from the final year project report of BIT student, Reg No E141041082, Rajapakshe RMM)*

Project Title: *Smart Car Park (holdOn)*

Aim:

To develop a web application and automated parking environment to address the smart car parking system using IoT technologies.

Objectives:

- *To conduct a critical review of existing smart car parking systems*
- *To do and in-depth study of technologies used to develop smart car parking systems*
- *To design and develop a web application and automated parking environment to address the problem*
- *To conduct a formal evaluation of the system*

5. Proposed Solution

<Here you may give a better heading to reflect your project. For example, the heading can be 'Character Recognition Using Artificial Neural Network, instead of the generic title Proposed Solution. This is also one of the major sections of the proposal. In this section, you should describe the solution as detailed as possible. As such you should write about technology to be adopted, nature of solution (input, output, process, users etc.), feasibility of implementation of the solution, your capability to solve the problem, and availability of resources. If relevant, add a figure for this section.>

References and Citations

<Your writing must be supported by some sources of information. That information should be listed under a title called 'References' at the end of the body of the proposal. The items in the list of references are referred inside the body of the text, and they are called citations. There are various referencing and citation styles, and you must use the following style in the project proposal. The reference styles for Books, Journal papers, papers in conference proceedings and web are slightly different. However, all reference styles report on essential information such as author, year, title of the paper and publisher in the given order. The number appearing within square brackets in front of

each entry is used to cite the particular reference inside the body of the text.>

Guidelines on how to use references can be found from below links.

IEEE Reference Style

http://www.lib.mrt.ac.lk/images/User%20Education_%20Guidelines_IEEE.pdf

APA Reference Style

http://www.lib.mrt.ac.lk/images/User%20Education_%20Guidelines_APA.pdf

Note that everything you included in the list of references must necessarily be cited inside the body of the text.

Referencing Tools

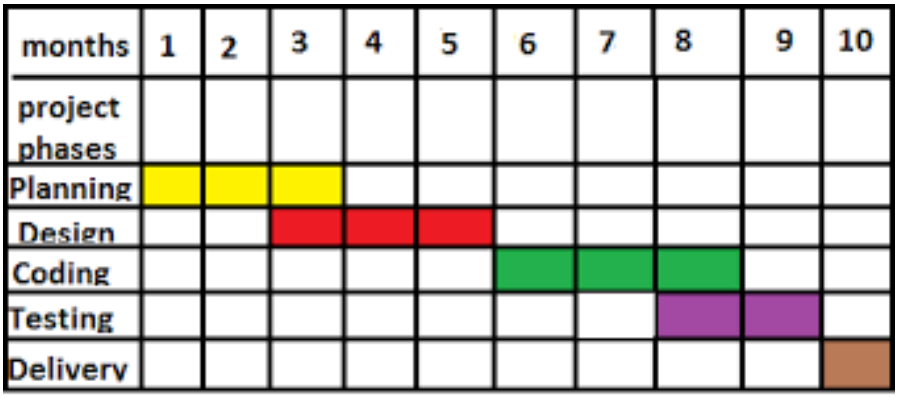
These referencing tools will help you format your references correctly and/or keep them organized so you can easily incorporate them in your assignments and dissertations.

Mendeley *https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gv6_HuCYExM*

Zotero *https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HwCL3qozuB4*

Appendix A - Plan of Action

It is better to include a plan of actions as an appendix. This may be cited in the section 'Proposed Solution'. This is a list of activities together with intended dates for their completion. In order to decide on the time scale, you must refer to the project duration prescribed (About 08-10 months) by the Faculty. The list of activities must be defined as per the objectives of the project. You can also use a Gantt chart for more detailed project timetable. <This is just an example; it may vary according to your schedule>



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Acknowledgement

This document was prepared based on the following sources;

1. http://www.lib.mrt.ac.lk/images/User%20Education_%20Guidelines_IEEE.pdf
2. http://www.montana.edu/usp/apply/research-proposals.html
3. http://rgs.usu.edu/undergradresearch/proposals/
4. http://undergradresearch.northwestern.edu/proposal-writing